

## **Windows With Missing Parts**

The Finder windows are what you might call “full-featured windows”—they have all the controls that we’ve discussed here. Windows that can’t be resized won’t have a zoom box or a grow box. Some windows can’t be closed, so they may be missing a close box. Some won’t even have a title in their title bar, or they may be missing a title bar entirely (indicating that they can’t be moved).

And, of course, in some cases the elevator and gray areas may be missing entirely, like the left/right scroll bar in our example—this indicates that the entire document fits horizontally within the window’s current boundaries. If the contents of a window can never be arranged in such a way as to need scrolling in a certain direction, the window might not even have a scroll bar for that direction—some windows always contain the entire document, so they never have scroll bars.

So when you’re confronted with a window, you can tell almost immediately what actions are allowed just by looking for the controls we’ve discussed.

## **Modal Windows**

Modal windows are windows that demand your attention. They have a double-line border all the way around their perimeter and they don’t go away until you’ve dealt with them. You can’t use the pull-down menus or do anything but work the controls in them. We’re talking about alerts and dialogs, of course—they are, in reality, stripped-down windows.

### **▲ By The Way...**

The term “modal” comes from the word “mode.” The Desktop tries to stay as far away from modes as it can—instead of limiting your actions depending on what mode the program is in, you usually can choose to do any operations in any order. Most importantly, you should always have access to the menu bar, instead of having to exit the “working with a document” mode to enter a “menu” mode the way you do in programs like AppleWorks. But sometimes modes just can’t be avoided. When you Initialize a disk in the Finder, for example, it just doesn’t make any sense to let you do anything else until you’ve finished with the dialog.

## **Windoids**

Windoids are, as their name implies, objects that look like windows but aren’t, exactly. The System 6 Video Keyboard (Figure 5M) is a windoid. Like a real window, there’s a “title bar” to allow you to drag the windoid around the screen, but no actual title. The title bar looks undernourished—it’s small and gray. There’s also a close box on the left end of the title bar.

The main difference between windows and windoids is that windoids always stay on top of the window stack. It is impossible to bring a window in front of a windoid. That doesn’t mean that you can’t work as you usually do—windoids don’t actually get in your way. The computer will always work with the topmost real window, ignoring the windoid and behaving as it always did. The only difference is that the windoid is always on your screen and can’t be covered up.